# Danaher Corporation (DHR)

**$211.25** (Stock Price as of 02/19/2026)

Price Target (6-12 Months): **$224.00**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Long Term: 6-12 Months | **Zacks Recommendation:** (Since: 03/31/25) Prior Recommendation: Underperform | **Neutral** |
| Short Term: 1-3 Months | **Zacks Rank:** (1-5) | **3-Hold** |
| | Zacks Style Scores: | VGM:C |
| | Value: D \| Growth: D \| Momentum: B | |

## Summary

Strong momentum in Danaher's bioprocessing business, fueled by rising demand for consumables from pharmaceutical customers, is driving growth in the Biotechnology unit. Strength in the clinical diagnostics businesses bodes well for the Diagnostics segment. Its commitment to return value to its shareholders is encouraging. Benefits from acquired assets are driving the company's performance of late. Through Danaher's DBS initiatives, it has been able to reduce the impact of supply-chain constraints and inflationary pressures. However, the company is plagued by weakness in the Life Sciences segment. An increase in SG&A expenses may affect the margin performance. High debt levels may raise the company's financial obligations and drain its profitability. Also, forex woes are weighing on Danaher's top line.

## Price, Consensus & Surprise(1)

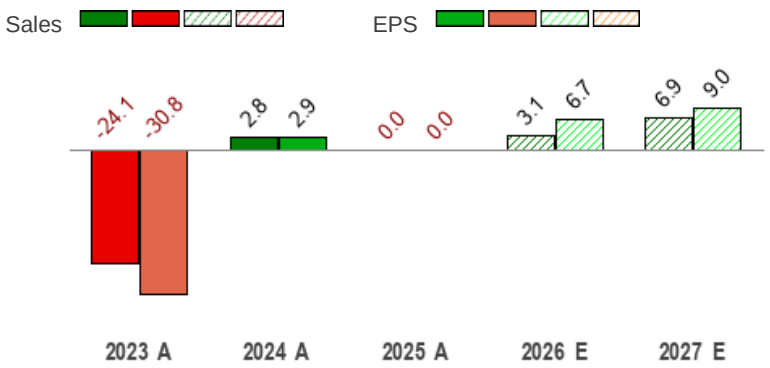
## Data Overview

| | |
|---|---|
| 52 Week High-Low | **$242.80 - $171.00** |
| 20 Day Average Volume (sh) | **4,757,660** |
| Market Cap | **$149.2 B** |
| YTD Price Change | **-7.7%** |
| Beta | **0.91** |
| Dividend / Div Yld | **$1.28 / 0.6%** |
| Industry | **Medical Services** |
| Zacks Industry Rank | **Bottom 40% (145 out of 243)** |

| | |
|---|---|
| Last EPS Surprise | **0.5%** |
| Last Sales Surprise | **0.6%** |
| EPS F1 Est- 4 week change | **-0.1%** |
| Expected Report Date | **04/28/2026** |
| Earnings ESP | **0.3%** |

| | |
|---|---|
| P/E TTM | **27.1** |
| P/E F1 | **25.4** |
| PEG F1 | **3.2** |
| P/S TTM | **6.1** |

## Sales and EPS Growth Rates (Y/Y %)(1)




## Sales Estimates (millions of $)(1)

| | Q1 | Q2 | Q3 | Q4 | Annual* |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2027 | | | | | 27,082 E |
| 2026 | 5,993 E | 6,153 E | 6,199 E | 6,990 E | 25,335 E |
| 2025 | 5,741 A | 5,936 A | 6,053 A | 6,838 A | 24,568 A |

## EPS Estimates(1)

| | Q1 | Q2 | Q3 | Q4 | Annual* |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2027 | | | | | 9.07 E |
| 2026 | 1.98 E | 1.93 E | 1.96 E | 2.45 E | 8.32 E |
| 2025 | 1.88 A | 1.80 A | 1.89 A | 2.23 A | 7.80 A |

*Quarterly figures may not add up to annual.

1) The data in the charts and tables, including the Zacks Consensus EPS and sales estimates, is as of 02/19/2026.
2) The report's text and the price target are as of 02/20/2026.

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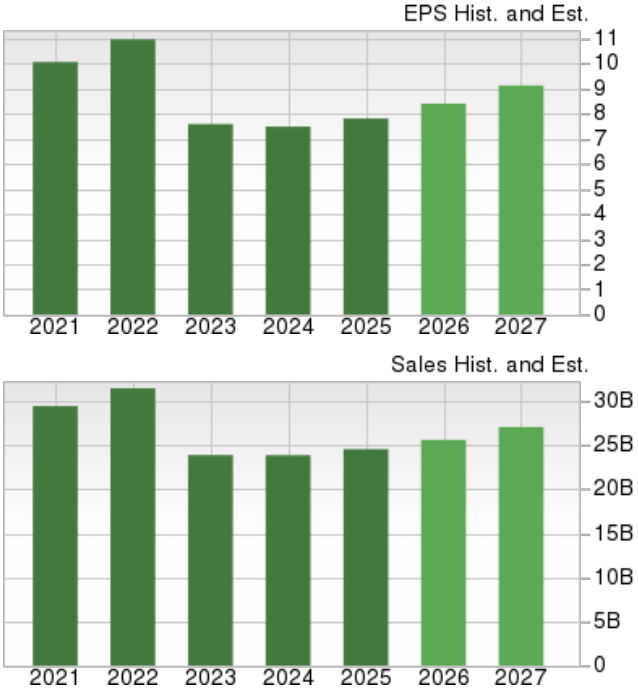
## Overview

Danaher Corporation is a global conglomerate that designs, manufactures and markets diverse lines of professional, industrial, commercial and consumer products. It is headquartered in Washington, DC.




*As of 02/19/2026*

On a geographical basis, the company has operations in the North America (43.1% of 2024 net revenues), Western Europe (23%), other developed markets (5.2%) and high-growth markets (28.7%). Exiting 2024, it has an employee base of 63,000 people. The company's segmental details are provided below:

Diagnostics segment (40.5% of revenues generated in 2025) offers analytical instruments, reagents, consumables, software and services that are deployed in reference laboratories, hospitals, physicians' offices and other critical care settings. It helps diagnose diseases and make suitable treatment decisions. Leica Biosystems, a medical devices unit within the segment, develops and supplies clinical diagnostics to the pathology market. Another unit, Beckman Colter, manufactures and sells products relevant to biomedical testing.

Life Sciences segment (29.9%) provides a broad range of research tools used to analyze a range of critical areas — including genes, proteins, metabolites and cells — to understand the causes of diseases, identify new therapies and test new drugs and vaccines. The range of industries served includes biopharmaceutical, food and beverage, medical, aerospace, microelectronics, and general industrial. In addition, the segment offers products and consumables that are designed to filter and remove contaminants from various liquids and gases in several end-market applications.

Biotechnology segment (29.6%) includes bioprocessing and discovery and medical businesses. It provides a wide range of tools, consumables and services utilized in the research, development, manufacturing and delivery process of biological medicines. The company's solutions support biotherapeutics that range from replacement therapies like vaccines, insulin, recombinant proteins and other biological drugs to mRNA, novel cell, gene and other nucleic acid therapies.

In September 2023, the company spun off its Environmental & Applied Solutions segment into an independent public company. The separation helps Danaher focus more on its core Life Sciences and Biotechnology segments.

*As of 02/19/2026*

## Reasons To Buy:

Strength in the Biotechnology and Diagnostics segments, accretive acquisition and the DBS initiatives bode well for Danaher. Shareholder-friendly policies raise the stock's appeal.

- Strength in Danaher's bioprocessing business, driven by an increase in demand for consumables from large pharmaceutical customers, has been supporting the Biotechnology segment's growth. Also, solid demand from pharmaceutical customers for monoclonal antibodies (mAbs) has been buoying the bioprocessing business. In the fourth quarter of 2025, orders in the bioprocessing business increased for the tenth consecutive quarter. For 2026, Danaher anticipates core revenues from the bioprocessing business to increase in high single-digits on a year-over-year basis. Also, strength in the discovery and medical business, driven by an increase in demand for medical and lab filtration consumables, bodes well for the **Biotechnology segment**. In 2025, core revenues from the segment increased 6.5% year over year. For the first quarter of 2026, Danaher anticipates core revenues from the Biotechnology segment to increase in high-single digit on a year-over-year basis.

- Strength in the molecular diagnostics business, driven by an increase in demand for non-respiratory disease tests, has been supporting the performance of the **Diagnostics segment**. Solid momentum in the clinical diagnostics businesses, led by growth in the Beckman Colter Diagnostics unit, has been buoying the segment as well. The segment's core revenues increased 1.5% on a year-over-year basis in 2025. However, lower sales in China, owing to a volume-based procurement program and healthcare reimbursement changes, are concerning.

- The company believes in expanding its market presence, solidifying its customer base and enhancing product offerings through **acquisitions**. In February 2026, Danaher inked a deal to acquire Masimo Corp. for $9.9 billion. The addition of Masimo's advanced sensor technology and AI-enabled monitoring will enable Danaher to enhance its diagnostics portfolio. The acquired company will operate as a standalone company within the Diagnostics segment, alongside Radiometer, Leica Biosystems, Cepheid and Beckman Coulter Diagnostics. Subject to customary closing conditions, the acquisition is expected to close in the second half of 2026. In December 2023, Danaher acquired Abcam plc, a global supplier of protein consumables, for approximately $5.7 billion. This acquisition expanded the company's Life Sciences segment. Abcam's long track record of innovation, outstanding product quality and breadth of antibody portfolio are expected to help Danaher solve some of the world's most significant healthcare challenges.

- T**he Danaher Business System (DBS) initiatives**, which help Danaher focus more on product innovation, superior product quality, efficient workforce building and shareholder value enhancement, are fostering the company's growth. The company has been able to reduce the impact of supply-chain constraints and inflationary pressure through its DBS initiatives. As part of the DBS initiatives, disciplined cost management, enhanced productivity and pricing actions have supported the company's performance. While lower volumes in Life Sciences are expected to weigh on the company's margins in first-quarter 2026, the benefits of the DBS initiatives are likely to offer respite.

- Danaher remains committed to rewarding its shareholders handsomely through **dividend payments**. In 2025, Danaher paid dividends of $878 million, up 14.3% year over year. The company paid out dividends of $768 million in 2024. In February 2025, Danaher hiked its dividend by 18.5% to 32 cents per share. The company has a dividend payout ratio of 16% and an annualized dividend yield of 0.6%.

## Reasons To Sell:

- Lower demand across academic and government end-markets has been weighing on Danaher's microscopy and mass spectrometry businesses under the **Life Sciences segment**. The company has been witnessing a sales decline in the life science instruments business due to lower demand for equipment. Core revenues from the Life Sciences segment declined 1.5% on a year-over-year basis in 2025. Softness in the life science consumables businesses, owing to lower demand for the plasmids and mRNA product lines in North America and reduced funding from biotechnology and academic research customers, remains concerning for the segment. For the first quarter of 2026, Danaher anticipates core revenues from the Life Sciences segment to be flat or to decrease in low single-digits on a year-over-year basis.

> Weakness in the Life Sciences segment, increasing SG&A expenses and high debt levels are worrisome for Danaher.

- Danaher has been dealing with the adverse impacts of **high costs and expenses**. In 2025, the company's cost of sales rose 3.9% year over year due to higher input costs and product mix changes. Danaher's selling, general and administrative (SG&A) expenses increased 6.1% year over year in 2025 due to the costs incurred for productivity improvement actions and high impairment charges. In the same period, the metric, as a percentage of net sales, increased 100 basis points to 33.5%. Research and development expenses also increased 0.9% year over year in 2025. Also, the persistence of tariff-related concerns might also inflate costs related to the parts and materials Danaher uses to make products. Escalating expenses, if not controlled, are likely to hurt the company's bottom line in the quarters ahead.

- **High debt levels** are concerning for Danaher as they raise financial obligations and may drain its profitability. Danaher exited fourth-quarter 2025 with a long-term debt of $18.4 billion compared with $15.5 billion reported at the end of fourth quarter 2024. Its current liabilities were $6.80 billion, higher than the cash equivalents of $4.62 billion. Also, interest expenses at the end of the fourth quarter remained high at $265 million. High debt levels can increase its financial obligations and prove detrimental to profitability in the quarters ahead.

- Danaher has operations in multiple nations. Such business diversifications expose it to risks stemming from **unfavorable movements in foreign currencies**, geopolitical issues and other headwinds. Also, the company's business is overseen by several U.S. and non-U.S. governmental and self-regulatory entities. The entities ensure Danaher's compliance with multiple regulations related to import laws, export control and economic sanction laws. Further, any change in governmental regulations may curb demand for the company's product or service portfolio and raise expenses.

## Last Earnings Report

### Danaher Q4 Earnings Beat Estimates, Life Sciences Sales Up Y/Y

| FY Quarter Ending | 12/31/2025 |
|---|---|
| Earnings Reporting Date | Jan 28, 2026 |
| Sales Surprise | 0.64% |
| EPS Surprise | 0.45% |
| Quarterly EPS | 2.23 |
| Annual EPS (TTM) | 7.80 |

Danaher's fourth-quarter 2025 adjusted earnings of $2.23 per share beat the Zacks Consensus Estimate of $2.22. The bottom line increased 4% year over year.

Danaher reported net sales of $6.84 billion, which beat the consensus estimate of $6.79 billion. The metric increased 4.5% year over year, driven by the impressive performance of all the segments.

It's core sales increased 2.5% year over year in the quarter. Foreign-currency translations had a positive impact of 2.5%, while acquisitions/divestitures had an adverse impact of 0.5%.

In 2025, it reported net revenues of $24.6 billion, which increased 3% year over year. The company's adjusted earnings were $7.80 per share, up 4.5% year over year.

### Segmental Discussion

Revenues from the Life Sciences segment totaled $2.09 billion, up 2.5% year over year. The Zacks Consensus Estimate for the segment's revenues was pegged at $2.06 billion. Core sales increased 0.5% year over year. Foreign-currency translations had a positive impact of 2%. Operating profit was $336 million compared with $376 million reported in the year-ago quarter.

Revenues from the Diagnostics segment totaled $2.72 billion, up 3% year over year. The Zacks Consensus Estimate for the segment's revenues was pegged at $2.71 billion. Core sales increased 2% year over year, while foreign currency had a positive impact of 2% on sales. However, acquisitions/divestitures impacted sales by 1%. Operating profit was $713 million, up 14.3% on a year-over-year basis.

Revenues from the Biotechnology segment totaled $2.03 billion, up 9% year over year. The Zacks Consensus Estimate for the segment's revenues was pegged at $2.02 billion. Core sales increased 6% year over year, while foreign-currency translations had a positive impact of 3%. Operating profit was $540 million, up 6.3% year over year.

### Danaher's Margin Profile

In the fourth quarter, Danaher's cost of sales increased 8.5% year over year to $2.87 billion. Gross profit of $3.97 billion increased 2% year over year. The gross margin was 59.1% compared with 59.5% in the year-ago quarter.

Selling, general and administrative expenses of $2.03 billion increased 0.1% on a year-over-year basis. Research and development expenses were $438 million, down 0.9% year over year.

Danaher's operating profit increased 5.4% year over year to $1.50 billion. Operating margin declined to 19.1% from 20.4% in the year-ago quarter.

### Balance Sheet and Cash Flow

Exiting the fourth quarter, it had cash and equivalents of $4.62 billion compared with $2.08 billion at 2024-end. Long-term debt was $18.4 billion at the end of the quarter compared with $15.5 billion at the end of December 2024.

Danaher generated net cash of $6.42 billion from operating activities in 2025 compared with $6.69 billion in the previous year's comparable period. Capital expenditures totaled $1.16 billion in the same period, down 17% year over year. Adjusted free cash flow decreased 0.3% year over year to $5.3 billion in 2025.

In the same period, it paid out dividends of $878 million, up 14.3% on a year-over-year basis.

### Danaher's Outlook

For the first quarter of 2026, Danaher expects adjusted core sales from continuing operations to increase in the low single digits on a year-over-year basis.

The metric is anticipated to increase 3-6% on a year-over-year basis in 2026. The company expects adjusted earnings to be $8.35-$8.50 per share.

## Recent News

**Acquisition of Masimo — Feb. 17, 2026**

Danaher inked a deal to acquire Masimo Corp. for $9.9 billion. The addition of Masimo's advanced sensor technology and AI-enabled monitoring will enable Danaher to enhance its diagnostics portfolio. The acquired company will operate as a standalone company within Danaher's Diagnostics segment, alongside Radiometer, Leica Biosystems, Cepheid and Beckman Coulter Diagnostics. Subject to customary closing conditions, the acquisition is expected to close in the second half of 2026.

**Dividend Update — Dec. 9, 2025**

Danaher's board approved a quarterly cash dividend of 32 cents per share, payable to shareholders on Jan. 30, 2026, of record as of Dec. 26, 2025.

## Valuation

Danaher's shares are down 8% in the year-to-date period and up 0.3% over the trailing 12-month period. While stocks in the Zacks sub-industry are down 1.4% in the year-to-date period, while those in the Zacks Medical sector are up 2.3%. Over the past year, the Zacks sub-industry and the sector are up 6.5% and 2% respectively.

The S&P 500 index is up 0.1% and up 17% in the year-to-date period and over the past year respectively.

The stock is currently trading at 24.84X forward 12-month price-to-earnings, which compares to 15.90X for the Zacks sub-industry, 21.40X for the Zacks sector and 22.59X for the S&P 500 Index.

Over the past five years, the stock has traded as high as 34.76X and as low as 21.53X, with a 5-year median of 27.24X. Our Neutral recommendation indicates that the stock will perform in line with the market. Our $224 price target reflects 26.08X forward 12-month earnings.

The table below shows summary valuation data for DHR

**Valuation Multiples - DHR**

| | | Stock | Sub-Industry | Sector | S&P 500 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| P/E F12M | Current | 24.84 | 15.9 | 21.4 | 22.59 |
| | 5-Year High | 34.76 | 18.78 | 23.51 | 23.8 |
| | 5-Year Low | 21.53 | 13.2 | 17.78 | 15.73 |
| | 5-Year Median | 27.24 | 15.43 | 20.62 | 21.23 |
| P/Sales F12M | Current | 5.78 | 0.48 | 2.24 | 5.22 |
| | 5-Year High | 8.12 | 0.92 | 3.31 | 5.64 |
| | 5-Year Low | 5.02 | 0.43 | 2.01 | 3.82 |
| | 5-Year Median | 6.4 | 0.62 | 2.62 | 5.07 |

*As of 02/19/2026* *Source: Zacks Investment Research*

## Industry Analysis(1) Zacks Industry Rank: Bottom 40% (145 out of 243)

## Top Peers(1)

| Company (Ticker) | Rec | Rank |
|---|---|---|
| Bunzl PLC **(BZLFY)** | Neutral | 3 |
| Honeywell International Inc. **(HON)** | Neutral | 3 |
| Markel Group Inc. **(MKL)** | Neutral | 2 |
| 3M Company **(MMM)** | Neutral | 3 |
| Sumitomo Corp. **(SSUMY)** | Neutral | 2 |
| Carlisle Companies Incorporated **(CSL)** | Underperform | 4 |
| Griffon Corporation **(GFF)** | Underperform | 5 |
| Icahn Enterprises L.P. **(IEP)** | NA | NA |

## Industry Comparison(1) Industry: Medical Services

| | DHR | X Industry | S&P 500 | CSL | HON | MMM |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | Industry Peers | | |
| **Zacks Recommendation (Long Term)** | Neutral | - | - | Underperform | Neutral | Neutral |
| **Zacks Rank (Short Term)** | 3 | - | - | 4 | 3 | 3 |
| **VGM Score** | C | - | - | B | D | C |
| Market Cap | 149.22 B | 436.05 M | 40.73 B | 16.67 B | 153.05 B | 86.93 B |
| # of Analysts | 13 | 3 | 22 | 5 | 8 | 6 |
| Dividend Yield | 0.61% | 0.00% | 1.36% | 1.08% | 1.98% | 1.89% |
| **Value Score** | D | - | - | C | D | D |
| Cash/Price | 0.03 | 0.16 | 0.04 | 0.06 | 0.08 | 0.07 |
| EV/EBITDA | 23.47 | 4.74 | 14.86 | 13.59 | 18.65 | 16.65 |
| PEG Ratio | 3.24 | 1.69 | 1.98 | 1.29 | 3.53 | 2.31 |
| Price/Book (P/B) | 2.84 | 1.81 | 3.64 | 9.49 | 10.18 | 18.47 |
| Price/Cash Flow (P/CF) | 18.58 | 10.95 | 15.00 | 16.44 | 18.29 | 15.46 |
| P/E (F1) | 25.39 | 16.26 | 19.32 | 19.39 | 23.16 | 19.24 |
| Price/Sales (P/S) | 6.07 | 1.15 | 3.16 | 3.32 | 3.79 | 3.48 |
| Earnings Yield | 3.97% | 4.36% | 5.15% | 5.16% | 4.32% | 5.20% |
| Debt/Equity | 0.35 | 0.10 | 0.57 | 1.60 | 1.81 | 2.30 |
| Cash Flow ($/share) | 11.37 | 0.18 | 9.47 | 24.79 | 13.16 | 10.67 |
| **Growth Score** | D | - | - | B | C | C |
| Hist. EPS Growth (3-5 yrs) | -6.02% | -3.14% | 7.75% | 22.70% | 8.18% | -5.74% |
| Proj. EPS Growth (F1/F0) | 6.67% | 15.07% | 9.41% | 8.35% | 6.34% | 6.45% |
| Curr. Cash Flow Growth | 1.78% | -3.07% | 7.58% | -7.96% | 7.11% | 5.04% |
| Hist. Cash Flow Growth (3-5 yrs) | 3.09% | 5.74% | 8.09% | 13.99% | 5.55% | -4.12% |
| Current Ratio | 1.87 | 1.68 | 1.18 | 3.09 | 1.30 | 1.71 |
| Debt/Capital | 25.95% | 25.69% | 38.14% | 61.61% | 64.36% | 69.72% |
| Net Margin | 14.71% | -0.86% | 12.79% | 14.76% | 12.74% | 13.03% |
| Return on Equity | 10.81% | 2.51% | 17.00% | 41.58% | 40.64% | 95.36% |
| Sales/Assets | 0.30 | 0.77 | 0.53 | 0.85 | 0.52 | 0.65 |
| Proj. Sales Growth (F1/F0) | 3.10% | 5.57% | 5.34% | 1.10% | 5.20% | 4.30% |
| **Momentum Score** | B | - | - | C | B | B |
| Daily Price Chg | 1.29% | 0.00% | -0.28% | 0.50% | -0.15% | 0.54% |
| 1 Week Price Chg | -1.86% | 0.00% | 0.43% | 1.28% | 1.26% | -0.48% |
| 4 Week Price Chg | -12.01% | -8.10% | -0.74% | 13.90% | 8.19% | 2.75% |
| 12 Week Price Chg | -7.53% | -7.53% | 0.72% | 28.97% | 26.73% | -3.37% |
| 52 Week Price Chg | 1.59% | -10.12% | 12.17% | 18.81% | 13.92% | 10.71% |
| 20 Day Average Volume | 4,757,660 | 276,190 | 3,243,738 | 549,249 | 4,283,376 | 4,250,919 |
| (F1) EPS Est 1 week change | 0.00% | 0.00% | 0.00% | 0.00% | 0.18% | 0.00% |
| (F1) EPS Est 4 week change | -0.11% | 0.00% | 0.08% | -1.63% | 1.56% | 0.75% |
| (F1) EPS Est 12 week change | 0.59% | 0.00% | 0.27% | -2.20% | -0.53% | -0.16% |
| (Q1) EPS Est Mthly Chg | -2.82% | 0.00% | -0.19% | -3.97% | -3.29% | 0.78% |

## Zacks Stock Rating System

We offer two rating systems that take into account investors' holding horizons: Zacks Rank and Zacks Recommendation. Each provides valuable insights into the future profitability of the stock and can be used separately or in combination with each other depending on your investment style.

## Zacks Recommendation

The Zacks Recommendation aims to predict performance over the next 6 to 12 months. The foundation for the quantitatively determined Zacks Recommendation is trends in the company's estimate revisions and earnings outlook. The Zacks Recommendation is broken down into 3 Levels; Outperform, Neutral and Underperform. Unlike many Wall Street firms, we have an excellent balance between the number of Outperform and Neutral recommendations. Our team of 70 analysts are fully versed in the benefits of earnings estimate revisions and how that is harnessed through the Zacks quantitative rating system. But we have given our analysts the ability to override the Zacks Recommendation for the 1200 stocks that they follow. The reason for the analyst over-rides is that there are often factors such as valuation, industry conditions and management effectiveness that a trained investment professional can spot better than a quantitative model.

## Zacks Rank

The Zacks Rank is our short-term rating system that is most effective over the one- to three-month holding horizon. The underlying driver for the quantitatively-determined Zacks Rank is the same as the Zacks Recommendation, and reflects trends in earnings estimate revisions.

## Zacks Style Scores

The Zacks Style Score is as a complementary indicator to the Zacks rating system, giving investors a way to focus on the highest rated stocks that best fit their own stock picking preferences.

Academic research has proven that stocks with the best Value, Growth and Momentum characteristics outperform the market. The Zacks Style Scores rate stocks on each of these individual styles and assigns a rating of A, B, C, D and F. We also produce the VGM Score (V for Value, G for Growth and M for Momentum), which combines the weighted average of the individual Style Scores into one score. This is perfectly suited for those who want their stocks to have the best scores across the board.

| | |
|---|---|
| Value Score | D |
| Growth Score | D |
| Momentum Score | B |
| VGM Score | C |

As an investor, you want to buy stocks with the highest probability of success. That means buying stocks with a Zacks Recommendation of Outperform, which also has a Style Score of an A or a B.

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